

Also, not having a system that is user-friendly can sabotage the best-laid plans of any beginning bulk buyer. Sticking that case of creamed corn in the back of the closet might seem like a good idea at first, but if you can't get to it when you need it (or forget it's there altogether), it does you absolutely no good to have it on hand. Further, don't forget to honor who you are and how you live your life. Choose an organizational and implementation system that flows with your particular home and lifestyle.

Analyzing the deals

Not every bulk-purchasing opportunity is a smart buy. A strong working knowledge of the per unit costs on items you regularly buy is extremely helpful. One item that can assist you with this is a price book.

Keeping it sexy

Basically, how do you remain excited enough about bulk buying and pantry stocking to stick with it and not get bored? The consumable infrastructure category really comes into play here. When you have the base ingredients to make most things, it's easier to get excited about strolling for the perfect avocado or planning a romantic dinner. I know I have more fun under those conditions popping into the grocery store for a few things if we want to have a "date night" quality dinner, than if I am trying to

do that along with stocking up for the month or quarter on certain items. Having the freedom and flexibility to try a few new things keeps us focused.

That's bulk buying 101 in as much of a nutshell as I can put it. If you've been holding off on this powerful money-saving strategy, this article should hopefully give you an affordable jumping-off point.

— **Myscha Theriault**

11 Strategies to Shop Your Way to Financial Independence

Love to shop? Just can't stop? A slight shift in your paradigm and perspective could lead you out of debt ... and straight to the bank.

Shopping is something we all need to do. There's no way around it. We shop for food, clothing, vehicles, home repair supplies, gas, credit card rates, long-distance plans, school supplies, and more. How can this be turned from financial drain to financial gain?